Our Featured Speaker



Mayflower Society Historian

GSMD DNA Committee Member

Marguerite M. Moffatt was born in Wappingers Falls, New York, and was raised in upstate New York before making her home in Walker, Louisiana.

A nurse practitioner by training, Marguerite built her career with ExxonMobil Corporation, retiring in 2021. She served as U.S. clinical coordinator for the company's U.S. clinics and as Business Venture Manager for a global information technology project that deployed medical software in twenty-seven countries. She was also a Data Privacy business contact, working with the corporation's data privacy office, and a member of the corporate audit team, conducting internal audits around the world. The habits of that career, careful documentation, respect for sensitive data, and an auditor's eye for whether the evidence supports the conclusion, now shape her genealogical work.

Marguerite descends from Mayflower passengers John Alden and Priscilla Mullins. She volunteers as a Historian for the Mayflower Society, preparing lineage applications for prospective members, and serves on the DNA Committee of the General Society of Mayflower Descendants (GSMD). Her committee work focuses on Y-DNA, particularly Big Y-700 testing, as a way to test documented lineages against genetic evidence. She has been closely involved with the Doty surname project, in which nearly one hundred descendants of Edward Doty have completed Big Y-700 tests, and with the Bonham surname project. She also develops training materials to help Historians use DNA evidence appropriately in lineage work.

With fellow DNA Committee members, Marguerite co-authored "Was John Rickard's Wife Mary Snow the Granddaughter of Peter Brown? DNA Results Offer Additional Evidence," published in *Mayflower Descendant* 73 (Summer 2025): 129–38. The article combines probate records with mitochondrial DNA results from the matrilineal descendants of Mary (Snow) Rickard and of Mayflower passenger Peter Brown's wife to examine a long-standing but unsourced claim of Mayflower descent.

Marguerite is also a member of the Daughters of the American Revolution through her Patriot ancestor, Pierre Lamoreaux.